PDF forms are not compatible with the Google Chrome PDF viewer plug-in. Chrome users should save the form, then reopen and complete with Adobe reader.

EE/RPF

For use from May/November 2027

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Student personal code:

Extended essay - Reflection and progress form

Student: *This form is to be completed by you and your supervisor during the progress and completion of the extended essay. It records your progress through the extended essay process and includes your reflective statement addressing your extended essay experience. You must undertake three formal reflection sessions with your supervisor: The first formal reflection session should focus on your initial ideas and how you plan to undertake your research; the interim reflection session takes place once a significant amount of your research has been completed, and the final session will be in the form of a viva voce, once you have completed and handed in your extended essay. This document acts as a record in supporting the authenticity of your work. Following the viva voce, you write a* ***reflective statement*** *of no more than 500 words., which must be included on the RPF.*

The completion of this form is a mandatory requirement of the extended essay. It must be submitted together with the completed essay. The reflective statement will then be assessed under Criterion E. Students and supervisors should be aware that a mark of 0 will be awarded by the examiner for criterion E if the RPF is blank or the reflective statement is written in a language other than that of the accompanying essay.

Supervisor: *You must have three reflection sessions with each student, one early in the process, an interim meeting and then the final viva voce. Other check-in sessions are permitted but do not need to be recorded on this sheet. After each reflection session you must record the month that the reflection session took place, the student's year of DP study at that time and initial the form.*
By submitting this student work for assessment, you are taking responsibility for its authenticity. No piece of student work should be uploaded/submitted to the e-Coursework system if its authenticity is in doubt.

First reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Interim reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Final reflection session – Viva voce

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

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Reflective statement

(No more than 500 words, written in the same language as the accompanying extended essay)

Throughout my exploration of the influence of changing times on art, I sought to understand how historical and contemporary works inform one another, focusing on the enduring legacy of Clara Peeters' Flemish still-life paintings. By comparing Peeters' work with that of post-contemporary artists Rebecca Ruetten and Audrey Flack, I aimed to trace the evolution of still-life painting and the dialogue between artists across different eras.

One of the most significant aspects of this research was recognizing the importance of context in interpreting art. For example, Peeters' intricate still-lifes, created during the early 17th century, are not just representations of objects but reflections of the cultural and social values of her time. Her meticulous attention to detail and the symbolism in her work offered a glimpse into the past, revealing how artists communicate through visual language. This understanding allowed me to see how Ruetten and Flack, working centuries later, draw upon similar themes and techniques to comment on their own contemporary societies. This realization marked a shift in my perspective, leading me to appreciate the ways in which art not only evolves but also retains connections to its historical roots.

However, as I delved deeper into my research, I encountered a significant challenge: the lack of primary sources for Clara Peeters. I anticipated this difficulty, knowing that primary documents such as personal letters, diaries, and sketches from artists of her time are often scarce or nonexistent. This limitation forced me to rely on secondary sources, which, while informative, lacked the direct insight that primary sources could provide. This was a critical learning moment, as it highlighted the importance of primary evidence in constructing a well-rounded argument. In contrast, researching Audrey Flack and Rebecca Ruetten was less problematic, as contemporary artists typically have more readily available primary sources, including interviews and published works.

This experience taught me the value of adaptability in research. Although I couldn't access the primary sources I initially hoped for, I learned to work with the materials available, critically evaluating secondary sources and drawing connections between them.

In reflecting on the process, I realized that my initial focus on the direct influence of Peeters on Ruetten and Flack may have been too narrow. The broader understanding I gained of the ongoing conversation between artists across time has encouraged me to think more expansively about art history. This change in perspective has influenced my decision-making in both academic and creative projects, where I now consider not only the immediate impact of an artist's work but also its broader implications and connections to the past and future.

Ultimately, this research experience has deepened my appreciation for the complexity of artistic influence and the importance of context in understanding art. It has also equipped me with the skills to navigate the challenges of research, fostering growth that I will continue to apply in my academic and professional endeavours.

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